

OpenOffice supports user developed extensions. Find out more about the available extensions at <http://tinyurl.com/27sgj8>. You can also learn how to make your own extensions.

As an office suite, Ooo is more than sufficient for most needs. It is only the hegemony of MS Office in the marketplace that has created the inertia that prevents us from switching to it. It would seem that OpenOffice will find increased adoption as the Government tightens its grip on anti-piracy laws!

Virtual Iron

www.virtualiron.com/products/Free_Download.cfm

Virtualisation software allows you to run any operating system within another operating system. For example, Virtual Iron will allow you to run Windows XP on Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL), and vice versa. This capability has many uses—software testers can set up different configurations of the same operating system on a single machine, your main operating system can be Red Hat and you can have a virtual Windows XP, complete with all the relevant Windows applications running inside RHEL. One advantage with this kind of configuration is that the entire virtualised operating system resides as a single file on the host operating system (RHEL in this case).

Suppose you want to switch your machine, all you need to do is copy the file to your new machine, and the entire configuration plus all the data will be exactly as it was on the old machine. No cumbersome reinstallation process.

Virtual Iron started life as a software that allowed a single operating system to use multiple servers. This might sound a bit confusing, but in contrast, VMWare and Microsoft's Virtual PC allow you to run many operating systems on a single server. Conceptually, Virtual Iron was virtualising the underlying hardware, while VMWare was virtualising the operating platform. Still confusing? Forget it!